Pine Tree Elders Quorum Newsletter

The primary purposes of quorums are to serve others, build unity and brotherhood, and instruct one another in doctrines, principles, and duties

Upcoming Calendar Highlights

- Dec 5-13, Bellevue Festival of the Nativity

Recurring Activities:

- Tue/Thu @ 8:30 PM – Futsal
- Tue @ 3:00 PM – Pickleball
- 2nd Saturday each month, 10:30AM: Ward Temple Session

Monthly Message

Brothers,

In the recent general conference, Elder Timothy L. Farnes shared a message titled "Divine Appointments." He taught that when we look beyond our own plans and recognize the needs of those around us, ordinary encounters can become opportunities to minister as the Savior would.

As we enter November and approach Thanksgiving, this message gives us a meaningful way to think about gratitude. We often recognize our blessings by looking at what the Lord has given us. We can also express that gratitude by becoming an answer to someone else's prayers.

Ministering doesn't always require a scheduled visit or a formal conversation. It might mean checking in on a brother we haven't seen at church, visiting a family, offering practical help, or simply taking time to listen. The important thing is to see people as the Savior sees them and act with genuine love.

This month, I encourage each of us to look for those opportunities, both within our ministering assignments and in our everyday interactions. As we do, we can help others feel the Savior's love while strengthening our own relationship with Him.

I'm grateful for each of you and for the opportunity we have to serve together. May we make this Thanksgiving season more meaningful by not only counting our blessings, but by sharing them.

Chris Welch
Elders Quorum President
Pine Tree Ward

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Upcoming EQ Lessons

Date	Instructor	Scheduled Topic
11/15	Bro Ulrich	The Sculpting of Our Souls - Tamara W. Runia
11/22	Bro Tice	"How Long Will It Be Ere They Believe Me?" - Dale G. Renlund
11/29	TBD	5th Sunday
12/6	Bro Morgan	Quick to Help, Slow to Judge - Paul H. Sinclair

11/01 EQ Lesson Summary

Instructor: Bro Batschi

Talk: Trusting the Lord Through Tithes and Offerings - Patricio M. Giuffra



My wife often teaches a principle that has become very meaningful in our family: We keep the commandments because we love God, not merely because we hope to receive the blessings that come from obedience. Commandments are given to draw us closer to the Savior, to protect us, and to help us remain free from sin and many of the challenges the world presents.

This does not mean that we will be free from trials or difficulties. All of us will face moments of uncertainty, financial hardship, illness, or loss. Yet even when we do not understand the purpose of our trials, we can have the assurance that the Lord knows our circumstances, honors our obedience, and fulfills His promises in His own time and way.

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11/08 EQ Lesson Summary

Instructor:

Talk: Courage Born of Our Faith in Jesus Christ - Neil L. Andersen



As we choose faith in Christ, He blesses us with the courage, sometimes in very difficult situations, to choose the right, and as we manifest our courage to choose the right, our faith in Christ strengthens.
We rejoice in the faith in Jesus Christ and the spiritual courage we see in you, our members of the Church across the world.

It is our faith in Jesus Christ that gives us the desire to humbly kneel alone and pray to our Heavenly Father. In those quiet moments when we speak with our Heavenly Father privately, independently, we are given the increased courage to choose the right. As a young man, I heard President David O. McKay say, "The greatest battle of life is fought within the silent chambers of your own soul." As we courageously win the battles of the soul, our faith in our Savior multiplies.

📖 ✨ November *Come Follow Me* – Hearing God's invitation.

The Old Testament reaches some of its most tender and most challenging moments this month. Our November reading takes us to Babylon, where Ezekiel and Daniel lived as exiles far from home. Ezekiel saw dry bones breathe again and a healing river flow from the temple. Daniel and his friends held to their convictions when it cost them. Then Hosea and Joel describe a God who keeps inviting His people back, and Amos, Obadiah and Jonah show that He sends prophets because He isn't finished with us.

If you've felt far from where you want to be, or you've struggled to trust that things can change, this month is for you. Pick one week and read just one chapter, such as Ezekiel 37, Daniel 3, Hosea 14 or Jonah 4. Ask what the passage says about God's patience, and where it invites you to turn back. Bring a question to share, because these stories tend to open good conversations around the table.

brotherhood | duty | service

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Missionary and Family History Efforts – Calls to action

Missionary	Temple and Family History
• Pray daily to share the gospel and serve others • Refer friends who are ready to the missionaries • Share your testimony in normal, natural ways with others—in person or via technology	• Reserve a name in Ordinances Ready • Share a name with the temple • Make an appointment at the temple

Preparing for El Nino This Winter

Winter's Coming
Winter in the Pacific Northwest is predictable - it happens every single year - and most of us can still get caught flat-footed by it anyway. So let's consider a few things worth doing now, while it's still convenient, instead of during the first ice storm when the roads are bad and the stores are already picked over.

Check your home now, before the freeze. Take twenty minutes this week and walk your house. Check for drafts around doors and windows. If you've got exposed pipes - crawl space, garage, exterior wall - get some foam insulation sleeves on them before a hard freeze hits. A burst pipe costs a lot more than $15 in foam.

Power goes out. Plan like it will. Flashlights with fresh batteries, not the ones that have been sitting in a drawer since last year. A way to charge your phone without the wall outlet. If you've got a wood stove or a fireplace, make sure your wood's actually seasoned and easy to get to when it's dark and 34 degrees out. If you own a generator, perform a “test run” to make sure you know how to get it running and can confirm it’s still putting out power.

Your car needs its own kit. Keep a blanket, some traction aid (sand or kitty litter works), jumper cables, and a phone charger in the trunk. If you're driving into the mountains or somewhere remote, tell someone where you're going and when you expect to be back.

Food that doesn't need cooking. If the power's out for a few days, can you still eat? Doesn't need to be fancy - just enough that a cold snap doesn't turn into a crisis.

Winter's coming. It always does. Let's prepare now so we won’t be scrambling when it gets here. Feel free to contact Rick Woodruff at 253-334-3855 if you have any questions.